You need JavaScript enabled to use this service.

Cookies on Civil Service Jobs

We'd like to use analytics cookies so we can understand how you use Civil Service Jobs and make improvements.

We also use essential cookies to remember if you ve accepted analytics cookies.

fc39bd983831ae393b584e37cad2123f.17928

Accept analytics cookies

Reject analytics cookies

1792819973-7238433d6179d49da459cbb9a

change
Language
121
BQsDAAAABgoBMQAAAApzZWFyY2hwYWdlC
1224
yes
1792819973-7238433d6179d49da459cbb9a

Chief Information Security Officer

Ministry of Defence

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 15th November 2026

Reference number

486995

Salary

£115,000

This is an SCS Pay Band 1 role. The successful candidate should expect to earn £115,000 per annum. Existing Civil Servants on level transfer will retain their existing base salary. Candidates on promotion will have their substantive base salary increased by 10% or start on the minimum of the SCS PB1 scale of £86,000 per annum; whichever is higher.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

SCS Pay Band 1

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

MOD - Defence Nuclear

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology
Intelligence
Security
Senior leadership

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time

Number of jobs available

1

Contents

Location
About the job
Benefits
Things you need to know
Apply and further information

Location

MOD Main Building London. There is an expectation that a minimum of 60% of working time will be spent in the office. All work-related travel and subsistence costs will be reimbursed except when travelling to your base location in line with departmental policy.

About the job

Job summary

The Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) is a senior role within the Defence Nuclear Organisation (DNO), accountable for providing strategic leadership on cyber security matters. The role holds ownership of information security and cyber risk across DNO and provides strategic influence throughout the organisation, working across boundaries to ensure effective risk management and security practices. The position is critical for mainting a coherent enterprise view of information security risk and strengthening DNO s overall security posture.

The post-holder will operate in a challenging and evolving cyber threat environment, facing risks from hostile states, criminals, ransomware groups, and others. As DNO becomes increasingly digital and data-led, the expanding attack surface underscores the importance of strong cyber leadership to protect critical systems, information, and services.

Job description

- Provide strategic leadership and accountability for cyber security across DNO, including policy framework, secure-by-design principles, and alignment with government and MOD requirements.
- Lead and develop a specialist cyber security team, managing resources, budget, capability while providing clear and trusted advice to senior leaders and governance boards.
- Deliver independent oversight and assurance of cyber and technology risks, ensuring effective risk management and escalation of material risks.

Lead and coordinate senior responses to major cyber incidents, ensuring effective escalation, operational decision support, and post-incident learning.

Collaborate with internal and external stakeholders, including MOD CISO, Product Owners, and CIO leads, to embed security into digital, data, technology, and transformation initiatives.

Ensure cyber risk transparency through evidence-based reporting to support informed decision-making on resilience, mitigation, and investment.

Manage cyber security resources effectively to deliver value for money and maintain organisational resilience amid evolving threats.

Person specification

Expert knowledge of cyber security, information risk management and protective security, including cyber threats, risk mitigation and security controls.

Proven ability to develop and implement cyber security strategies, policies and control frameworks aligned with government, national and industry standards.

Strong analytical skills, with the ability to assess cyber threats, vulnerabilities and risks, challenge technical evidence, and provide clear advice to senior leaders.

Proven experience of leading responses to major cyber incidents, demonstrating sound judgement and effective decision-making in complex, high-pressure environments.

Strong strategic leadership capability, with the ability to set direction, drive improvement, and align cyber security outcomes with organisational objectives.

Strong communication, influencing and stakeholder management skills, with the ability to translate technical issues for non-technical audiences and deliver outcomes across complex organisations.

Desirable criteria may be used in the event of a strong field of candidates when there is a need to distinguish between candidates. This will be as a second sift, after the essential criteria has been considered:

Knowledge of technology services and secure delivery practices.

Ability to collaborate with suppliers delivering critical services, sharing incident and risk information to strengthen overall security posture.

Ability to evaluate emerging cyber threats, vulnerabilities in legacy systems, interdependencies across services, and security risks associated with new technologies such as artificial intelligence, applying national and MOD policies pragmatically.

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £115,000, Ministry of Defence contributes £33,315 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

Learning and development tailored to your role

An environment with flexible working options

A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity

A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

To apply for this post, you will need to complete the online application process accessed via the Civil Service Jobs portal. This should be completed

no later than 23:55 on Sunday 15 November 2026 and will involve providing the two documents which are weighted equally:

- A CV (no more than 2 pages) setting out your career history, with key responsibilities and achievements. Please ensure you have provided reasons for any gaps within the last two years.

- A Personal Statement (no more than 2 pages) providing tangible examples that clearly evidence how you meet the essential criteria for the role.

External candidates who join the MOD and are new to the Civil Service will be subject to a six-month probation period.

For further information about the role and full application process, please refer to the candidate pack attached below. If you wish to receive any material in a different format for accessibility, then please contact People-CivHR-SCSCandidateSupport@mod.gov.uk.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

This role has a minimum assignment duration of 3 years. An assignment duration is the period of time a Senior Civil Servant is expected to remain in the same post to enable them to deliver on the agreed key business outcomes. The assignment duration also supports your career through building your depth of expertise.

As part of accepting this role you will be agreeing to the expected assignment duration set out above. This will not result in a contractual change to your terms and conditions. Please note this is an expectation only, it is not something which is written into your terms and conditions or indeed which the employing organisation or you are bound by. It will depend on your personal circumstances at a particular time and business needs, for example, would not preclude any absence like family friendly leave. It is nonetheless an important expectation, which is why we ask you to confirm you agree to the assignment duration set out above.

Security

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is developed vetting (opens in a

new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

Open to UK nationals only.

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : SCS Recruitment Team

Email : People-CivHR-SCSCandidateSupport@mod.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : People-CivHR-SCSCandidateSupport@mod.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles, and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact People-CivHR-SCSCandidateSupport@mod.gov.uk in the first instance. If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission Civil Service Commission - Recruitment.

Civil Service Commission

disability confident LEADER